

DRONE CHALLENGE (UAV)

2026 & 2027 OFFICIAL RATING FORM

MIDDLE SCHOOL

Judges: Using minimal (1-4 points), adequate (5-8 points), or exemplary (9-10 points) performance levels as a guideline in the rating form, record the scores earned for the event criteria in the column spaces to the right. The X1 or X2 notation in the criteria column is a multiplier factor for determining the points earned. (Example: an "adequate" score of 7 for an X1 criterion = 7 points; an "adequate" score of 7 for an X2 criterion = 14 points.) A score of zero (0) is acceptable if the minimal performance for any criterion is not met.

Go/No Go Specifications

- Before judging the entry, ensure that the items below are present; indicate presence with a check mark in the box.
- If an item is missing, leave the box next to the item blank and place a check mark in the box labeled ENTRY NOT EVALUATED.
- If a check mark is placed in the ENTRY NOT EVALUATED box, the entry is not to be judged.

- ☐ TIER 1 – Drone, safety vests, and safety glasses
- ☐ TIER 2 – Documentation Portfolio
- ☐ ENTRY NOT EVALUATED

TIER 1 – MANUAL DRONE FLIGHT (60 points)		
Evaluation: Each team has three attempts. Drop the lowest score (do not record) and enter the two (2) highest scores.		
Highest Attempt Score (60 points)		
Second Highest Attempt Score (60 points)		
TIER 1 – MANUAL DRONE FLIGHT SUBTOTAL (120 points)		
Rules violations (a deduction of 20% of the total possible points for the above sections) must be initialed by the judge, coordinator, and manager of the event. Record the deduction in the space to the right. Indicate the rule violated: _____		
TIER 1 – SUBTOTAL (120 points)		

TIER 2 – DOCUMENTATION PORTFOLIO (70 points)				Record scores in the column spaces below.
CRITERIA	Minimal performance	Adequate performance	Exemplary performance	
	1-4 points	5-8 points	9-10 points	
Portfolio Components (X1)	Portfolio is unorganized and/or is missing three (3) or more components.	Portfolio has most components and is generally organized per the order of the event guide listing; it has sufficient content.	All components are included in the portfolio; content and organization per the order of the event guide listing are excellent.	
Explanation of the Problem(s) (X2)	Problem(s) to be solved by drone is/are difficult to understand or presented in an illogical manner.	Problem(s) to be solved by the drone is/are defined and communicated adequately.	Evidence of a clear definition and explanation of problem(s) to be solved by drone; explanation is presented in an organized manner.	
Communication of Solution(s) (X2)	It is difficult to understand the solution(s) being presented; there is little or no evidence of understanding drone capabilities.	The solution(s) is/are communicated; there is some evidence of research and understanding of drone capabilities and use.	The solutions(s) is/are communicated in a clear concise manner; there is solid evidence of in-depth research and understanding of drone capabilities and use.	
Research/Bibliography (X1)	The research is inadequate, and/or very few credible sources are referenced.	The research is adequate, and it includes a few credible sources.	The research is comprehensive, and credible resources are included.	
Work Log (X1)	The Work Log is not complete.	The Work Log is included and mostly complete.	The Work Log is complete and fully documents project work.	
TIER 2 – DOCUMENTATION PORTFOLIO SUBTOTAL (70 points)				
Rules violations (a deduction of 20% of the total possible points for the above sections) must be initialed by the judge, coordinator, and manager of the event. Record the deduction in the space to the right. Indicate the rule violated: _____				
PRELIMINARY SUBTOTAL (190 points)				

SEMIFINAL INTERVIEW (40 points)				Record scores in the column spaces below.
CRITERIA	Minimal performance	Adequate performance	Exemplary performance	
	1-4 points	5-8 points	9-10 points	
Knowledge (X2)	There is little or no evidence of understanding drone capabilities.	There is some evidence of research and understanding of drone capabilities.	There is solid evidence of in-depth research and understanding of drone capabilities and use.	
Application (X1)	Use of drone solution to problem(s) presented in an illogical manner.	Use of drone as solution to problem(s) communicated adequately.	Use of drone as solution to problem(s) presented clearly and concisely.	
Team Participation (X1)	Majority of the interview responses are made by one member of the team; a partner may be disengaged.	Both team members are generally engaged in the interview, though one member may take on more responsibility.	Both team members are actively involved in the interview and show understanding of the drone solution.	
SEMIFINAL INTERVIEW SUBTOTAL (40 points)				
Rules violations (a deduction of 20% of the total possible points for the above sections) must be initialed by the judge, coordinator, and manager of the event. Record the deduction in the space to the right. Indicate the rule violated: _____				
SEMIFINAL SUBTOTAL (40 points)				
To arrive at the TOTAL score, add any subtotals and subtract rules violation points, as necessary. TOTAL (230 points)				

Comments: I certify these results to be true and accurate to the best of my knowledge. JUDGE Printed name: _____ Signature: _____
